COURSE 2 · SECTION 6 · WORKED SOLUTION

Clean the change-log exports

Section 6 (videos S06.1 and S06.2) · Clean the change-log exports

DESIGN QUESTION

How many engineering changes are really in the log once the 21 monthly exports are combined and cleaned, and which part is the primary part of the most changes?

Steps (as built in the video)

1. Home > Manage Parameters > New Parameter: Name ChangeFolder, Type Text, Current Value = the Change_Exports folder path. OK.
2. Home > New Source > Folder > paste the path > OK > Combine > Combine & Transform Data (UTF-8, Comma). Rename the query Change_Exports to Changes. In its Source step (and in the Sample File query) replace the quoted path with ChangeFolder.
3. Delete the automatic Changed Type step. Set text types; Set dates (en-US): the 5 date columns, Change Type > Using Locale > Date, English (United States); Set cost (en-US): CostImpact_USD Decimal Number with the same locale.
4. Select PrimaryPart only > Transform > Format > Trim (Trim part); Format > UPPERCASE (Upper part); Home > Replace Values "-" with nothing (Remove hyphen).
5. Remove Source.Name (Drop Source.Name). Ctrl+A on the headers > Home > Remove Rows > Remove Duplicates (Remove exact duplicates). Close & Apply.

Optional: the same result in one hand-written query (Advanced Editor)

```
let
    Source   = Folder.Files ( ChangeFolder ),
    WithData = Table.AddColumn ( Source, "Data", each Table.PromoteHeaders (
                   Csv.Document ( [Content],
                       [Delimiter = ",", Encoding = 65001, QuoteStyle = QuoteStyle.Csv] ),
                   [PromoteAllScalars = true] ) ),
    Combined = Table.Combine ( WithData[Data] ),
    Typed    = Table.TransformColumnTypes ( Combined, {
        {"RequestDate", type date}, {"TriageDate", type date}, {"ApprovalDate", type date},
        {"ImplementDate", type date}, {"CloseDate", type date}, {"CostImpact_USD", type number},
        {"ChangeID", type text}, {"ParentChangeID", type text}, {"Reason", type text},
        {"Priority", type text}, {"PrimaryPart", type text}, {"Status", type text},
        {"NeedsRevalidation", type text}, {"Originator", type text}
    }, "en-US" ),
    Trimmed  = Table.TransformColumns ( Typed, {{"PrimaryPart", Text.Trim, type text}} ),
    Upper    = Table.TransformColumns ( Trimmed, {{"PrimaryPart", Text.Upper, type text}} ),
    NoHyphen = Table.ReplaceValue ( Upper, "-", "", Replacer.ReplaceText, {"PrimaryPart"} ),
    Deduped  = Table.Distinct ( NoHyphen )
in
    Deduped
```

Why the locale: the files use ISO dates (2025-01-23) and a dot as decimal separator. With a German or French regional setting, -721.0 could be read wrongly; the "en-US" locale fixes that for every user. Why the order: the 6 duplicates are exact copies, so Remove Duplicates gives 178 before or after the PrimaryPart clean-up; cleaning first is the safer habit, because a re-typed duplicate only becomes identical after cleaning. Source.Name must go first: the two copies of a change come from different files. Replace "-" only in PrimaryPart: ChangeID keeps its hyphen (ECR-3200).

The 14 fixed values are of three kinds: hyphen (P-500), lower case (p300) and trailing space ('P200 '). After the clean-up there are 8 PrimaryPart values, the same 8 PartIDs as the Parts sheet.

Expected result

Check	Result
CSV files combined	**21**
Rows after combine	**184**
Exact duplicate rows	**6**
Rows after Remove Duplicates	**178**
PrimaryPart values typed differently (fixed)	**14**
Distinct PrimaryPart values after cleaning	**8**
Changes with PrimaryPart = P300	**26**
Status = Closed	**154**